Personal Reflection – Sprint 1

During Sprint 1, my main accomplishment was conducting the feasibility analysis and making key technology recommendations for our project. I suggested that we develop a web application instead of focusing on Android or desktop platforms. This approach would ensure accessibility on any device with a browser, avoid the need for downloads, and allow faster development and testing within the semester timeline. After discussion, my teammates approved this idea. I also proposed the technology stack, recommending HTML, CSS, and JavaScript for the frontend, along with Java Spring Boot and MySQL for the backend. These suggestions were reviewed and agreed upon by the team. Additionally, I recommended narrowing the project scope to three core features daily word delivery, favorites, and quizzes so we could stay focused and avoid scope creep. Once again, my teammates supported this direction, which gave the project a clear and realistic technical foundation from the start.

The challenges I encountered mainly involved time and coordination. It was difficult to schedule meetings since everyone had different commitments, and at times, we ended up having last-minute discussions. This created pressure and limited our ability to refine ideas in advance. Another challenge was dividing responsibilities between frontend and backend development, since both required careful planning. We also had to make decisions on which languages and tools were best, which took longer than expected. While these issues slowed us down, they also gave me experience in adapting to group discussions and thinking critically about tradeoffs.

Through sprint 1, I learned more about my teammates' thought processes and how they approach problem solving. This gave me valuable perspective on collaboration. I also strengthened my leadership skills by guiding discussions toward consensus and helping the group settle on realistic technical choices. In addition, I learned new terminology and gained exposure to backend and frontend frameworks that I had not used before, which expanded my technical knowledge.

Looking ahead, I believe I can improve by scheduling and attending meetings earlier, so that we avoid heavy workloads and rushed decisions at the last moment. I also want to complete my contributions more quickly, which would give us extra time to refine and improve our work. By being proactive with planning and time management, I can ensure that both my individual performance and the team's overall process are stronger in the next sprint.